Youngjae Cho

ML Research Engineer
Seoul, South Korea

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youngjae-cho.github.io
GitHub | Google Scholar

I study robust and data-efficient learning from imperfect supervision: preference optimization, active learning, Bayesian adaptation, and reinforcement learning.

EDUCATION

KAIST | M.S., Industrial & Systems Engineering — Mar 2022 - Feb 2024
Advisor: Il-Chul Moon

KAIST | B.S., Industrial & Systems Engineering — Mar 2017 - Feb 2022

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

** Equal contribution.*

[1] **Learning Where It Matters: Geometric Anchoring for Robust Preference Alignment**
Youngjae Cho, Jongsuk Kim, Ji-Hoon Kim
NeurIPS 2026 | Accepted [Paper]

[2] **Make Prompts Adaptable: Bayesian Modeling for Vision-Language Prompt Learning with Data-Dependent Prior**
Youngjae Cho, HeeSun Bae, Seungjae Shin, YeoDong Youn, Weonyoung Joo, Il-Chul Moon
AAAI 2024 [Paper] [Code]

[3] **Sharpness-Aware Active Learning**
Yoon-Yeong Kim*, **Youngjae Cho***, JoonHo Jang, Byeonghu Na, Yeongmin Kim, Kyungwoo Song, Wanmo Kang, Il-Chul Moon
ICML 2023 [Paper] [Code]

[4] **Beyond Scalar IoU: Structured Verification from Rollout Groups for Video Temporal Grounding**
Youngjae Cho, Won Young Jhoo, Jongsuk Kim
arXiv 2026 | Preprint [Paper]

ACADEMIC SERVICE

ICML 2026
Gold Reviewer

NeurIPS 2026
Top Reviewer

AWARDS

NVIDIA Nemotron Hackathon
Winner, Track B | 2026

Team winner in Track B (Domain-Specialized Model).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Pyler | ML Research Engineer — Oct 2025 - Present

- Research on preference optimization and reinforcement learning for video temporal grounding.
- Multimodal model post-training and LLM/VLM-based content-safety supervision.

Aiv Co. | ML Research Engineer — Mar 2024 - Oct 2025

- Diffusion-based defect synthesis for industrial anomaly detection.

KAIST | Graduate Research — Mar 2022 - Feb 2024

- Bayesian vision-language prompt learning and sharpness-aware active learning.

ADDITIONAL PUBLICATIONS

[5] **Background-Aware Defect Generation for Robust Industrial Anomaly Detection**
Youngjae Cho, Gwangyeol Kim, Sirojbek Safarov, Seongdeok Bang, Jaewoo Park
arXiv 2024 | Preprint [Paper]